

Vendor Marketplace Platform with Escrow System – Developer Brief

1. Project Overview

This platform is a multi-vendor marketplace with an integrated escrow system. Buyers can purchase products safely, while vendors are guaranteed payment once delivery is confirmed. The system acts as a trusted middleman that holds funds until both parties complete the transaction successfully.

2. Core Concept

Instead of buyers paying vendors directly, all payments go through the platform. The platform holds the funds securely until the buyer confirms receiving the product. If any issue arises, the system allows dispute resolution before releasing funds.

3. Transaction Flow

1. Buyer selects product and places order. 2. Buyer makes payment to the platform. 3. Platform confirms payment and holds funds in escrow. 4. Vendor is notified to deliver the product. 5. Vendor ships/delivers the product. 6. Buyer confirms receipt of the product. 7. Platform releases funds to vendor after deducting fees. 8. If issues occur, a dispute is opened and resolved by admin.

4. Core System Modules

The system should include: - User management (buyers, vendors, admin) - Vendor shop system - Product listing system - Order management system - Escrow transaction system - Payment integration system - Dispute resolution system - Admin control dashboard

5. User Roles

Buyer: browses products, places orders, confirms delivery, opens disputes. Vendor: creates shop, uploads products, processes orders, ships items, receives payouts. Admin: manages users, approves vendors, monitors transactions, handles disputes, releases funds.

6. Key Features

Buyers should be able to register, browse, and buy securely. Vendors should manage products and track orders. Admin should oversee all activities. Escrow system must securely hold and release funds. Dispute system must allow evidence upload and resolution.

7. Revenue Model

The platform generates income through: - Escrow transaction fees - Commission on vendor sales - Vendor subscriptions - Featured product advertisements

8. Security Requirements

All payments must be verified before processing. Escrow funds must be securely tracked. User authentication must be protected. All admin actions must be logged. Disputes must include evidence for transparency.

9. Legal & Compliance

The platform must operate under a registered company. Terms of service, escrow policy, and privacy policy must be created. Compliance with Ghana financial and data protection regulations is required.

10. Long-Term Structure (Inheritance)

The system must be owned by the company, not an individual. All access credentials and operations should be documented. The business should run independently with staff support. Ownership can be transferred through shares to family members.

11. Recommended Technology

Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript. Backend: PHP. Database: MySQL. Payment: Mobile Money API integration. Hosting: Cloud or VPS server.